SAILFIN DRAGON

Hydrosaurus pustulatus

What can it see, hear, or feel?
A small third eye senses light, sharp eyes spot fruit and movement, and it feels currents in the water.

Where does it live — and why?
It lives along rivers and mangroves in the Philippines, basking in trees right above the water.

How does it send messages?
Males raise a tall sail on their back, turn darker, and bob their heads to show they are boss.

What does it do when something changes?
When a predator gets close, it drops from a branch into the river and hides underwater.

How does it learn?
Hatchlings are on their own from day one and learn by practicing swimming and diving.

How does it have babies?
A mother digs a nest near water and lays two to eight eggs that hatch after about sixty days.

What are its limits?
Without a river nearby, it has no escape, and loss of bank trees takes its basking spots.

What does this teach us?
The river is a refuge, a travel route, and a place to hide — all in one.

Think About This
If you could run on water for a short time,

What a living thing can sense becomes its reality. Environment shapes design.